

Automate *fsck* on all partitions

At start-up, I mount several other partitions automatically using *fstab*, and on those, after a number of mounts, get a warning that the drive should be checked. However, it's a pain in the neck to switch to Runlevel 1 and manually check all those partitions.

Why should I have to do that manually? Why can't I set my system check the filesystem at startup as it does for the root partition?

You can do this by editing a few lines in the */etc/fstab* file. You need to define *fsck-pass* entry in */etc/fstab*.

For example, in my */etc/fstab* file, I have:

```
# /etc/fstab: static file system information.
#
/dev/sda1 / ext2 defaults 1 1
/dev/sda2 none swap sw 0 0
/dev/sda3 none swap sw 0 0
proc /proc proc defaults 0 0
/dev/sda5 /usr ext2 rw 1 2
/dev/sda6 /tmp ext2 rw 1 2
/dev/sda7 /export/home/fuzzy ext2 rw 1 2
```

Notice that my last three filesystems are marked "pass 2", which means that they will get checked second, that is, after the root filesystem. Make sure you don't have a zero "0" in the "pass" column of your filesystem(s) for which you want *fsck* to be done automatically.

swap and *proc* never get checked for obvious reasons.

—Amit N. Bhakay, amit.nb@gmail.com

Running additional programs at boot time

The */etc/rc.d/rc.local* script is executed by the *init* command at boot time or when changing runlevels. Adding commands to this script is an easy way to perform necessary tasks at boot time, like starting special services or initialising devices without writing complex initialisation scripts in the */etc/rc.d/init.d/* directory and creating symbolic links.

The following is an example of how to add symbolic links to services:

```
S90apamassassin -> ../init.d/apamassassin
```

Usually, the number following *S* should be in the 90s to ensure that the supporting processes for this have already been started by *init*. You can also add your own scripts here so that they will run at boot time.

—Oracle, craigc99@gmail.com

Opening different Linux terminals through Putty

screen is a program that allows you to 'detach' from a running process/program, leave it running, and 'attach' from another computer or terminal—all without losing any work. Here is what you need to do—start the *screen* program:

```
screen
```

Now run a command and detach the *screen*. To detach, type *Ctrl+A+D*. To re-attach from some other computer, log in and issue the following command:

```
screen -x
```

screen allows you to work collaboratively on a console—every connected person can type or watch the others typing. You can teach others or even give support remotely.

Start *screen*. Tell your partner to 'attach' using the command:

```
screen -x
```

To make a log of your session to a plain-text file, type *Ctrl+A+H*. If you want to attach (*screen -x*) and there are multiple *screen* sessions available, the program will then list the available *screen* sessions. The following is a typical output:

```
There are screens on:
```

```
2463.pts=2.atreus (Attached)
11068.lab (Attached)
```

In this case, the user can explicitly specify the desired session using an unambiguous substring of the session name. In the above example, *screen -x 11068* and *screen -x lab* are equivalent, and both users will now share the same session.

Use of *screen* can be controlled while it is running by prefacing commands with the command-key character. By default, this is *Control+A*. For instance, to view the help *screen*, enter *Ctrl+A ?*. The detach command is *Control+A Control+D*. *Control+A Control+C* creates a new terminal *screen*. *Control+A* shows a list of terminal *screens* *Control+A N* switches to the next *screen*.

—Ajeet S Raina, ajeet.singh.raina@logica.com

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